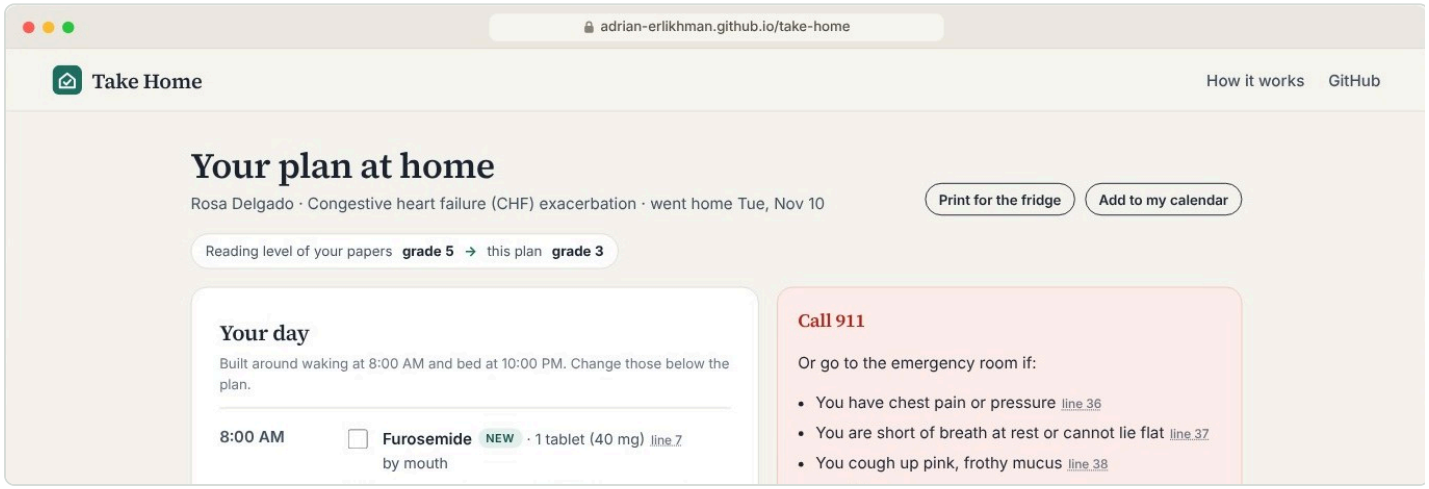
Take Home

Your hospital discharge papers, turned into a plan you can follow at home.

Adrian Erlikhman and Michael Tarekegn · built Nov 11–12, 2026 · Live: adrian-erlikhman.github.io/take-home · Code: github.com/adrian-erlikhman/take-home · Demo: youtu.be/SdFiaW_MIWU



The problem

Patients get the most instructions when they leave the hospital and have the least energy to read them. Discharge papers mix new, changed and stopped medicines in one list, use abbreviations like PO, BID and QHS, and put the warning signs at the end. About 36% of U.S. adults have basic or below-basic health literacy (2003 National Assessment of Adult Literacy). Small misreadings do harm: many people don't know Percocet contains acetaminophen, so they take Tylenol on top of it.

What it does

Paste the papers or load a PDF. Take Home builds:

- **Your day:** each medicine on a schedule built around when you wake and sleep, new and changed doses marked, "only if you need it" medicines kept apart with their limits, and stopped, held and every-other-day medicines in their own lists.
- **Warning signs** split into Call 911 and Call your doctor.
- **Appointments with real dates:** "in 7 days" becomes Tue, Nov 17.
- **For now:** restrictions with end dates ("until Mon, Dec 7").
- **Ask your pharmacist:** two medicines with acetaminophen, two NSAIDs, "as needed" with no limit, a medicine listed as both stop and take. It never changes a dose. It writes the question.
- Plain-language words, a one-page print for the fridge, and a calendar file with reminders. Every item links back to its line on the papers.

What's next

Spanish and Chinese versions of the interface, medication lists exported from patient portals, and testing with nurses who do discharge teaching.

How it's built

- Plain JavaScript, no build step, on GitHub Pages. No server and no account: health information stays on the device.
- **Reading** (js/parse.js): finds sections by their headings, then reads each medicine line for status, name, strength, amount, route, frequency, as-needed reason, daily maximum and duration. Follow-ups, warnings and restrictions become dates.
- **Planning** (js/plan.js): frequencies to clock times, pharmacist questions, reading level, the calendar file.
- PDFs are read in the browser with pdf.js. **21 automated tests** cover both samples, frequencies, amounts, dates, after-visit summaries, the safety checks, the calendar file and every AI guardrail.

Where AI fits, with guardrails

Optional, with the user's own Claude key, which stays in the tab:

- **Photo of printed papers:** Claude types up the page; the patient checks it against the paper first.
- **Unusual layouts:** Claude sorts lines into sections. A line that isn't in the papers word for word, numbers included, is dropped.
- **Ask about your papers:** Claude must quote the line it used. A quote that isn't in the papers, or a number the line doesn't have, and the answer isn't shown.
- **Translate:** a translation that changes, adds, drops or moves a number is thrown out.

Claude never decides a dose or a time.

The sample patients, hospitals and phone numbers are made up. Take Home is not medical advice: it rearranges what a care team wrote. In an emergency, call 911.